TCS – National Qualifier Test (NQT)

Route to Ninja, Digital and Prime roles | 2021–2027 batches

What it is	One test that places you into the Ninja, Digital or Prime hiring track based on your score. You do not choose a track while applying.
Batches	2021 to 2027
Last Date	Reported as 12 November 2026, with the exam on 24 November 2026. Another portal lists 7 October (exam 19 October), so confirm on TCS iON.
Pay (approx.)	Ninja ₹3.4 LPA (UG); Digital ₹7–7.5 LPA; Prime ₹9–11 LPA
Location	Across India

Eligibility

- UG, PG and diploma students in their pre-final or final year, or graduates of 2021–2027, in any stream.
- Freshers, or professionals with under 2 years of experience.
- Reported criteria: 60% or 6 CGPA throughout, no pending backlogs at selection, and an academic gap of up to 2 years.
- Register on the TCS NextStep portal under the IT category, then complete the application and apply for the drive.

Test Pattern

- The test has a foundation section with numerical, verbal and reasoning questions, and an advanced coding section.
- A strong advanced coding score moves you toward the Digital and Prime interviews.

How to Apply

Register at nextstep.tcs.com (IT category) and follow the TCS iON NQT instructions. The NQT score stays valid for two years.

Skills Required (suggested)

- Numerical ability, verbal ability and logical reasoning (from listing).
- Coding: strong advanced coding for Digital and Prime (from listing).
- One programming language, data structures and algorithms, and SQL basics.
- Communication for the technical and HR interviews.

Items marked (from listing) come from the job postings found online. The other items are general skills typically expected for this kind of role and are not part of the official posting.

Compiled on 1 November 2026 from job portals and official pages. Details can change, so verify on the official page before applying.